

James Tannahill

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Investor, operator, and builder with 10+ years across PE-backed, public, and growth-stage companies; currently at SpaceXAI / xAI building AI-native financial intelligence. Investment experience spans a third-generation family office, strategic finance at a NASDAQ biotech, alternative data research, and sell-side biotech coverage. Combines fundamental modeling depth (LBO, DCF, M&A, accretion/dilution) with hands-on engineering: designs and ships production Python/AWS ML and LLM systems end to end.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Fundamental & Event-Driven Research | Healthcare & Life Sciences | Alternative Data | Financial Modeling (LBO, DCF, M&A) | Due Diligence & Valuation | AI/ML Infrastructure & Applied LLMs | Python, SQL, AWS, NVIDIA CUDA | P&L Ownership | Capital Raises

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SpaceXAI / xAI - Corporate Finance

New York, NY | 2025 - Present

AI-native financial intelligence at the frontier of machine learning and capital markets.

- Contribute across the full model-training lifecycle (pre-training, mid-training, supervised fine-tuning, RLHF, and post-training alignment), architecting the financial-reasoning datasets, verifiable reward signals (RLVR), and graded evaluation suites that measurably lift frontier-model accuracy on institutional capital-markets reasoning.
- Author evaluation frameworks and binary-weighted grading rubrics spanning LBO, DCF, credit, and M&A / accretion-dilution; engineer adversarial, difficulty-gated tasks that isolate specific reasoning failure modes and discriminate between frontier models where standard benchmarks saturate.
- Ship production Python/AWS systems for real-time financial intelligence: probabilistic entity resolution (Fellegi-Sunter / term-frequency linkage), NLP signal extraction, and retrieval-augmented (RAG/OpenSearch) modeling applied to deal sourcing, due diligence, and portfolio monitoring at scale.
- Serve as the rare hire fluent in both finance and engineering, translating how investors actually underwrite (LBO/DCF judgment, credit analysis, deal structuring) into concrete model behavior, reward design, and evaluation tooling.

Plocamium Holdings (Family Investment Office) - Principal, then President

New York, NY | 2015 - 2025

Third-generation family investment office across healthcare, industrials, and manufacturing; scaled from principal to president. Parent entity of 1Ness Strategies and RDLB.

- Rose from principal to president of a platform that deployed \$400M+ across 30+ investments in healthcare services, life sciences, industrial technology, and manufacturing; personally originated, underwrote, and led 11 of those deals end to end, from sourcing through exit.
- Led a \$22M growth-equity investment in a surgical-implant manufacturer (35% revenue growth) and a \$25M investment in a healthcare-analytics platform; sourced and structured a \$3M co-investment in digital diagnostics.
- As lead investor and board member, drove double-digit EBITDA-margin expansion and strong IRR/MOIC across portfolio companies through pricing discipline, cost restructuring, and revenue-mix optimization.
- Built the investment thesis at the convergence of digital health, advanced analytics, and precision manufacturing.

1Ness Strategies (Plocamium operating company) - Co-Founder & CEO

New York, NY | 2023 - 2025

Founded within the family office: healthcare marketing, technology, and SaaS platform.

- Built healthcare services company from zero to 80+ clients and \$1.5M+ monthly managed revenue; profitable within 18 months on disciplined unit economics.
- Delivered 45% CAC reduction, 5x average ROAS, 80% qualified-lead lift; launched HLTHvrs.com SaaS for real-time PE portfolio benchmarking. Team of 12+.

RDLB (Plocamium affiliate) - Board Partner

New York, NY | 2024 - 2026

Capital markets advisory for PE-backed and growth-stage companies.

- Advise on \$150M+ in capital raises; investor communications frameworks reduced diligence cycles 25-30%. Governance restructuring contributed to 15-20% EV uplift.

Vaxart, Inc. (NASDAQ: VXRT) - AVP, Strategic Finance

New York, NY | 2021 - 2023

Clinical-stage biotechnology company; oral vaccine development.

- Led \$100M+ in strategic transactions: \$50M manufacturing facility acquisition and \$50M+ in BARDA/DoD non-dilutive grants; built NPV/DCF models tied to clinical milestones.
- Directed budgeting across R&D, manufacturing, and commercial; partnered with CEO and Board on strategic planning; extended cash runway 18+ months.

EARLIER CAREER

M Science (Jefferies Group) - Senior Associate

2019 - 2020

- Delivered alternative-data healthcare research to institutional investors (hedge funds, \$5B+ AUM); engineered Python analyses over proprietary transaction and consumer panels, cleaning and normalizing large-scale datasets and combining them with fundamental modeling to surface tradable signals ahead of consensus.

Accrete.AI - Associate

2018 - 2019

- Led go-to-market strategy and designed the data architecture for AI-driven healthcare analytics at a dual-use (defense/healthcare) NLP firm; built ingestion pipelines that curated Twitter/X API, news, and clinical text into training datasets, and deployed sentiment-analysis and entity-extraction models that surfaced investable signals. Secured partnerships with major health systems; presented to PIMCO and JPMorgan on roadshows.

H.C. Wainwright & Co. - Equity Research Analyst, Biotechnology

2016 - 2018

- Initiated coverage on 50+ biotech names; authored institutional research and built DCF and comparable-company valuation models. FINRA Series 7, 63, 86/87.

EDUCATION

Cornell University, SC Johnson College of Business - MBA | University of Essex - MSc Biotechnology | Denison University - BS Biochemistry

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Finance: Bloomberg, Capital IQ, Advanced Excel, Financial Modeling (DCF, LBO, NPV, M&A, accretion/dilution) **Programming:** Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn), SQL, AWS (Lambda, SageMaker, Bedrock, DynamoDB), Git **AI/ML:** LLM APIs (Claude, Grok), NLP/Entity Resolution, RAG, OpenSearch, local LLMs, Prompt Engineering, ML Pipelines

LEADERSHIP & AFFILIATIONS

Young Presidents' Organization (YPO) | Economic Club of New York | St. Francis Yacht Club | Cornell Club of New York | Student Sponsor Partners (Mentor) | Denison Sailing Team Captain; 1,000+ hrs coastal/open-ocean racing | Hurricane Island Outward Bound School alumnus | Hudson River Community Sailing